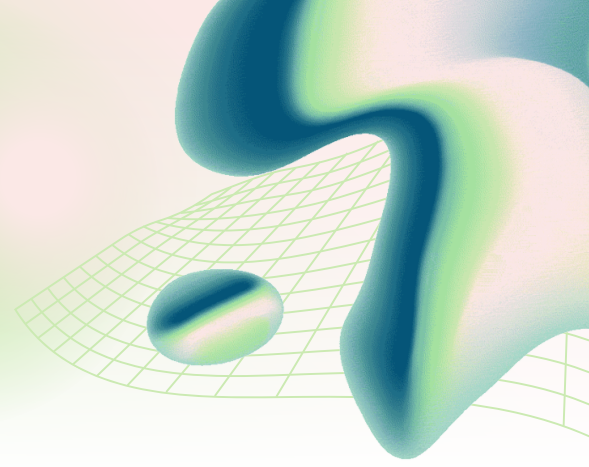


STARTING A NEW SCHOOL

A guide for young people



Embrace the New: What to Expect

Starting at a new school can feel like a big leap, but it's also an exciting opportunity! Think of it as a fresh start, a chance to meet new people, discover new interests, and create new memories. It's completely normal to feel a mix of excitement and nerves. Here's a breakdown of what you might experience and how to make the most of it:

- **First Impressions:** The first few days are all about getting oriented. You'll be learning new routes, figuring out locker combinations, and finding your way around the campus. Don't worry if you get a little lost – everyone does at some point!
- **Meeting New Faces:** This is your chance to connect with classmates, teachers, and staff. Everyone is in the same boat, so initiating conversations can be easier than you think. A simple 'Hi, I'm new here' can go a long way.
- **New Routines:** You'll be adjusting to new class schedules, homework expectations, and maybe even different lunch breaks. Give yourself time to settle into these new rhythms.
- **Opportunities Galore:** New schools often mean new clubs, sports teams, and activities. This is the perfect time to explore something you've always wanted to try or discover a hidden talent.
- **A Bit of Nervousness:** It's okay to feel anxious! New environments can be overwhelming. Acknowledge these feelings and remember that they usually lessen with time and familiarity.

Your Toolkit for Success

Be a 'Yes' Person (Within Reason!)

Say 'yes' to opportunities that come your way. Join a club, try out for a team, or volunteer for a school event. These are great ways to meet people who share your interests.

Be Open and Approachable

Smile! Make eye contact. Let your body language show that you're open to new connections. If someone smiles at you, smile back!

Ask Questions

Don't be afraid to ask for help. Whether it's directions to class, clarification on an assignment, or just asking someone what their favorite lunch spot is. Teachers and fellow students are usually happy to assist a newcomer.

Get Involved in Extracurriculars

This is arguably the best way to make friends and feel connected to your new school. Find a club, sport, or activity that genuinely interests you.

Prepare for Your First Day

Pack your bag the night before. Lay out your clothes. Knowing you're prepared can reduce first-day jitters.

Find a Buddy

See if the school has a buddy program for new students, or if there's someone in your class who seems friendly and you could ask to show you around.

Stay Connected with Old Friends

While it's important to make new friends, don't forget about your existing support system. Text, call, or video chat with your old friends to share your experiences and get encouragement.

Focus on the Positives

When you feel overwhelmed, take a moment to focus on something good. Did you have a nice chat with someone? Did you understand a new concept in class? Celebrate the small wins!

Your New School Adventure: Activity Time!

Let's put your new knowledge into action! This activity will help you visualize and prepare for your new school experience.

Create Your 'New School Survival Kit'

Imagine you're packing a special kit for your first week at your new school. What items, both physical and mental, would you include to help you feel confident and prepared?

Instructions:

1. **Brainstorm:** Think about the tips we've discussed and what personally makes you feel ready for new challenges.
2. **List Your Items:** Below, list at least 5-7 items for your survival kit. These can be real objects you'd pack, or more abstract things like 'a positive attitude' or 'a list of questions'.
3. **Explain Your Choices:** Briefly explain why each item is important for your new school adventure.

My New School Survival Kit:

- Item 1: _____

- *Why it's important:* _____
- **Item 2:** _____
 - *Why it's important:* _____
- **Item 3:** _____
 - *Why it's important:* _____
- **Item 4:** _____
 - *Why it's important:* _____
- **Item 5:** _____
 - *Why it's important:* _____
- **Item 6:** _____
 - *Why it's important:* _____
- **Item 7:** _____
 - *Why it's important:* _____

Bonus: What's one thing you're most excited about for your new school?
